GRADE 10 / Business Studies / English

Know the business environments

01 Understand

Learning goals: Classify a business influence • Explain levels of control • Suggest a practical response

The micro environment is inside the business: its vision, resources and functions. Management usually has substantial control over it.

The market environment includes customers, suppliers and competitors. A business can influence relationships but cannot fully control these parties.

The macro environment includes wider economic, social, technological and other external forces. Businesses usually adapt to these rather than control them.

Three lenses for a school stationery shop

Event	Environment	Possible response
Poor staff scheduling	Micro	revise shifts
Supplier delays	Market	find a second supplier
Economy-wide cost increases	Macro	review budget and prices

02 Follow the reasoning

A stationery shop loses sales because staff arrive late and a competitor offers delivery. Classify and respond.

1. Late staff: micro environment. The owner can set attendance expectations and improve scheduling.

2. Competitor delivery: market environment. The owner can investigate customer needs and offer a feasible delivery option.

3. Explain why the response fits the cause instead of giving the same generic recommendation for both.

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Practise with purpose

03 Try before checking

Use paper or your notebook. Show your reasoning. For written responses, use evidence and explain your choices. Suggested time: 15–20 minutes.

1. Classify a new internal staff training programme.

2. Classify a new competing shop.

3. Why can a small shop not simply eliminate economy-wide inflation?

04 Check and correct

1. Micro: internal skills and staffing.

2. Market: a competitor operates in the external market.

3. Inflation is a wider economic influence beyond the individual firm’s control; the firm must adapt.

Common mistake to avoid

An event outside the premises is not automatically macro. Customers and suppliers belong to the market environment.

Reflect and revisit

Identify one correction in your own words. Attempt a similar question tomorrow without looking at the guide. If you are still unsure, take your attempt to a teacher or tutor.

Coverage and sources

CAPS topic focus: Business environments: micro, market and macro

DBE CAPS, Grades 10–12: Business Studies. Section 3 content and skills. This is a focused supplement, not a complete syllabus or prescribed literature replacement.

Open the official DBE curriculum reference

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